In that way, Russia and China are regularly involved in building a multipolar world order. And also, both countries were committed to constructing a multipolar world order. Later, again, during Putin's visit to China on May 20 in 2014. In the meeting of the Chinese Deputy Foreign Minister, Cheng Guoping (2014) stressed that China and Russia should develop strategic cooperation in bilateral cooperation and enhance the interaction in the practical sphere. They must also cooperate in ensuring peace, stability, and the creation of multipolar world order. Evidently, these countries propelled themselves to establish regional and inter-regional groups to foster their relations. Groups like SCO, BRICS, RIC, IBSA, and BASIC are prominent and influential. Still, the evolution of BRICS has made the idea of a multipolar world order more engaging due to its growing clout in world affairs.

Both Russia and China have established and promoted regional and inter-regional forums and groups in the process. And become very active and vocal as part of their strategy, encouraging and convincing other like-minded nations. Furthermore, other southern world countries have started realizing their importance globally, forming regional and inter-regional organizations and groups to put forward their interests globally. In this instance, BRICS, IBSA, BASIC, SCO, and RIC are quintessential examples of modern-day changing world politics. As mentioned above, BRICS has maximum political clout and say in these groups.

Theoretical Underpinning of the BRICS Group

Thus, the scholarly and relevant approach to analyzing BRICS (Brazil, Russia, India, China, and South Africa) is under its nearly universal nature. The evolution of BRICS has created an 'uncomfortable' or exceptional case for research. Earlier, IR theorists primarily tried to apply the study of BRICS in an institutional manner or through an international mode of scholarship, which was a substandard approach and did not work (Sergunin 2015: 74). Such research also lacked empiricism. However, the popular neo-realist theory, 'Power Transition Theory,' developed by A. F. K. Organeski (1958), and his followers Wittkopf (1997) and Tammen et al. (2000)—comes closer to a theoretical method in studying BRICS. This theory is apt to describe the rise of BRICS within international relations (ibid.). It primarily argues that the

> This theory aims to explain the cause of international conflicts and wars through the rise of emerging powers, which are discontent with international rules established by dominant powers. (ibid.)

According to the power transition theory, states can be classified into 'status quo' and 'revisionist.' However, this theory still falls short of a sufficient understanding of BRICS because BRICS nations do not belong to either of these